

Project XTC – Development Edition 0.1

Chapter 10 – Transport: Staying in the Flow

The transport section is where many users first appreciate the value of a dedicated control surface. Instead of repeatedly moving between keyboard, mouse and screen, the essential playback controls remain under your fingertips throughout a recording or mixing session.

The Transport Controls

The X-Touch provides dedicated buttons for REW, FF, STOP, PLAY, RECORD and LOOP. When DrivenByMoss is correctly configured these buttons control Bitwig's transport directly, with no MIDI mapping required.

Developing Good Habits

Rather than reaching for the space bar, make PLAY and STOP your default way of starting and stopping playback. Keeping one hand on the X-Touch makes it easier to move immediately from listening to adjusting a fader or encoder.

Recording

Before recording, select the destination track using its SELECT button. Arm the track in Bitwig if required, position the playhead, then press RECORD. Because the controller already knows which track has your attention, it becomes natural to move from recording into mixing without changing your working position.

Loop Playback

The LOOP button is especially useful while balancing a mix or designing sounds. Loop a short musical phrase and make repeated adjustments from the X-Touch. Continuous playback lets you hear the effect of every change immediately.

Field Note #013

If the transport buttons do nothing, don't assume they are faulty. First check that the DrivenByMoss controller is online and that the X-Touch scribble strips are displaying Bitwig information. A silent transport usually indicates that communication has been lost.

Exercise

Load a project and avoid the computer keyboard for ten minutes. Use only the X-Touch transport controls while navigating, auditioning changes and balancing levels. Notice how quickly the controls become second nature.

Key Takeaways

- Use the dedicated transport controls instead of the keyboard whenever practical.
- SELECT the track before recording or editing.
- LOOP is invaluable when making repeated adjustments.
- A non-responsive transport usually indicates a connection problem, not a hardware fault.

Before You Continue...

The next chapter explores the PLUGIN button and Device Mode, where the X-Touch becomes a hands-on editor for Bitwig devices and plug-ins.